



Colorado State Committee Meeting – May 28, 2026

Executive Session Minutes

Meeting Place:	Via TEAMS
Members Present:	Don Brown, Chairperson Kyle McConnell, Member Steve Raftopoulos, Member Joe Petrocco, Member
Staff Present:	Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist Woody Woods, District Director Scott Brase, District Director
Guests:	Dara Belew, CED – for Otero/Crowley COC items only

1. Call to Order

The Colorado State Committee (STC) met on May 28, 2026, via TEAMS. Don Brown, State Committee Chairperson opened the Executive Session at 10:20 a.m.

2. Approve Executive Session Minutes

A April 23, 2026, Minutes

The STC reviewed the Executive Session minutes from the April 23, 2026, meeting. After reviewing the minutes, Kyle McConnell, made a motion to approve the minutes as presented. Steve Raftopoulos seconded the motion. Motion passed.

3. Conservation Reserve Program (CRP)

A 321 Equitable Relief – Misaction/Misinformation – Alamosa – Oklahoma Judicial Process Servers LLC

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the case file (Exhibit 1) to review and make a determination on the request for Equitable Relief- Misaction/Misinformation submitted by the Alamosa/Costilla COC on behalf of Oklahoma Judicial Process Servers LLC for the Misaction/Misinformation on the Grassland CRP

Signup 206 offer on tract 1663. If relief is granted, Alamosa/Costilla COC also requests a contract effective date of 10/01/2024.

Discussion/Facts:

- The September 13, 2024, approval of the CRP-1 was not properly loaded in the Conservation On-line System (COLS).
- The contract was approved prior to obtaining an interim or final conservation plan.
- The contract was approved prior to obtaining the required CCC-941 Average Adjusted Gross Income form for all required participants.
- Producer signatures were not obtained by the Alamosa Acting CED on the CRP-1 and CRP-2G as required by CRP policy prior to official offer submission.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 1), Kyle McConnell, moved to recommend DAFP approve the Equitable Relief Request-Misaction/Misinformation submitted by the Alamosa/Costilla County Committee on behalf of Oklahoma Judicial Process Servers LLC for the Misaction/Misinformation on the Grassland CRP Signup 206 offer on tract 1663. In addition to having the effective date be October 1, 2024. Steve Raftopoulos seconded the motion. Motion passed.

4. Conservation Reserve Program (CRP)

A Establishment of additional FY26 CRP Cost Share component and rate

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 2 to review and make a determination on establishing additional CRP cost share components and rates for 2026.

According to Handbook 2-CRP (Rev.6) paragraph 495, STC's are authorized to develop a state program and C/S policy based on guidelines established within Handbook 2-CRP (Rev. 6). STC's can also establish state rates rather than having COC's establish individual county rates. Colorado STC has elected to continue with implementing state rates.

The FY 26 CRP Cost Share Rates were established by the previously Colorado STC. However, it has determined that the following, additional cost share component and rate was needed for FY 2026 and future years:

STC Approved: PY26 additional CRP component and rate

Component Code	Description	Measurement	Rate	Type of Rate
26COCR1001	Post Fire-Mulching (Straw)	Acre	\$125.00	Not to Exceed

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation in Exhibit 2 and STC knowledge, Kyle McConnell moved to add the proposed CRP Component and increase the recommended rate to \$125.00 as a Not to Exceed rate as shown above. Joe Petrocco seconded the motion. The motion passed.

5. Emergency Forest Restoration Program (EFRP)

A Establishment of additional FY2026 EFRP Cost Share components and rates

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 3 to review and make a determination on establishing additional EFRP cost share components and rates for 2026.

According to Handbook 1-EFRP(Rev.1) subparagraph 66A, the STC will review and determine EFRP cost share rates annually.

The FY 26 EFRP Cost Share Rates were established during the April Colorado STC meeting. However, it was determined that the following, additional cost share rates are needed for FY 2026:

STC Approved: PY26 additional EFRP component and rate

Component Code	Description	Measurement	Rate	Type of Rate
26COEFRP24	Woven Wire	Feet	\$8.50	Not to Exceed
26COEFRP22	Multistrand Barbed/Smooth Wire Very Difficult Terrain	Feet	\$13.88	Not to Exceed

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation in Exhibit 3, Steve Raftopoulos moved to add the proposed components and the proposed rate as presented and shown above. Kyle McConnell seconded the motion. The motion passed.

6. Emergency Conservation Program (ECP)

A Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 4 to review agricultural market land value established by the Rio Blanco COC for 2026.

The Rio Blanco COC took action on April 9, 2026 and set the agricultural market land value for Rio Blanco County as follows:

- Rangeland: \$2,250/acre
- Dryland Cropland: \$2,500/acre
- Irrigated Cropland: \$11,550/acre

STC reviewed applicable policies and supporting documentation in Exhibit 4. STC concurred. No action required by STC.

7. Noninsured Crop Disaster Assistance Program (NAP)

A 2026 – Crop Table Review

1) Cucumbers

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the information in Exhibit 5 to review and make a determination on County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Cucumbers as recommended in the table below.

2026 STO Approved yield and price

County	Type	IU	Ir/ Ni	UOM	CEY	Price	Organic Yield	Transiti onal Yield	Organic Price	Direct Market Price
Crowley	ENG	FH	I	TON	8.63	\$404.06				525.27
Fremont	COM	FH	I	TON	5.26	\$404.06				525.27
Otero	ENG	FH	I	TON	6.80	\$404.06				525.27
Otero	PKL	FH	I	TON	6.36	\$434.48				564.82
Pueblo	COM	FH	I	TON	5.80	\$404.06				525.27
Pueblo	ENG	FH	I	TON	6.71	\$404.06				525.27
Pueblo	PKL	FH	I	TON	5.74	\$434.48				564.82
Weld	COM	FH	I	TON	6.62	\$404.06				525.27
Weld	ENG	FH	I	TON	4.97	\$404.06				525.27
Weld	PKL	FH	I	TON	5.18	\$434.48				564.82

Intended Use Key: CB=cannabidiol, DE= dry edible, FB=fiber, FG=forage, FH=fresh, GR=grain, NT=non-table, OL=oil, PR=processed, SD=seed, SG=silage, SO=sod, TB=table

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 5), Kyle McConnell moved to approve the proposed County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Cucumbers as presented and shown in the table above for the 2026 NCT. Kyle McConnell, seconded the motion. Motion passed.

B New Crop Requests for NCT

1) 2025 San Miguel Triticale Fg Ni

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 6 to review and make a determination on a new non-irrigated (Ni) practice for Triticale with the intended use of forage (Fg) to be added as a NAP covered commodity for 2025 and succeeding years in San Miguel County.

STC determined the crop is not an experimental crop for San Miguel County.

2025 STO Approved NCT Data.

PP Factor	UH Factor	Certified Organic Factor	Transitional Organic Factor	Final Planting Date	Normal Harvest Date	Application Closing Date
0.77	0.93			05/15	10/31	09/01

Unit of Measure in tons	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
Yield	0.39	1.31	1.10	0.33	0.57	0.10

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6), Kyle McConnell moved to approve the San Miguel a County's request to add a new non-irrigated (Ni) practice for Triticale with the intended use of forage (Fg) as a NAP covered commodity for 2025 and succeeding years in San Miguel County as presented and shown above. Steve Raftopoulos seconded the motion. Motion passed.

2) Dolores Mixfg LGG Fg Ir

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 6 to review and make a determination on a new irrigated (Ir) practice for Mixed Forage, Legume, Small Grain, Grass interseeded (LGG) with the intended use of forage (Fg) to be added as a NAP covered commodity for 2025 and succeeding years in Dolores County.

STC determined the crop is not an experimental crop for Dolores County.

2025 STO Approved NCT Data.

PP Factor	UH Factor	Certified Organic Factor	Transitional Organic Factor	Final Planting Date	Normal Harvest Date	Application Closing Date
0.25	0.75			07/01	10/15	12/01

Unit of Measure in tons	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
Price	\$150.00	\$228.00	\$168.00	\$202.00	\$206.00	\$215.00
Yield	1.65	1.85	1.70	1.01	1.65	1.39

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 7), Kyle McConnell moved to approve the Dolores County's request to add a new irrigated (Ir) practice for Mixed Forage, Legume, Small Grain, Grass interseeded (LGG) with the intended use of forage (Fg) as a NAP covered commodity for 2025 and succeeding years in Dolores County as presented and shown above. Joe Petrocco seconded the motion. Motion passed.

3) Rio Blanco Mixfg GMA Fg Ir and Mixfg GMA Fg Ni

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 8 to review and make a determination on adding to the NCT Grass Mix Alfalfa (GMA) for forage (fg) with both an irrigated (Ir) and non-irrigated (Ni) practice as a NAP covered commodity for 2025 and succeeding years in Rio Blanco County.

STC determined the crop and practices are not an experimental crop for Rio Blanco County.

2025 STO Approved NCT Data

PP Factor	UH Factor	Certified Organic Factor	Transitional Organic Factor	Final Planting Date	Normal Harvest Date	Application Closing Date
-	0.75			-	10/15	12/01

Unit of Measure in tons	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
Price	\$150.00	\$228.00	\$221.00	\$236.00	\$244.00	\$225.00
Mixfg GMA Fg Ir	0.67	0.46	0.90	0.895	0.85	0.70
Mixfg GMA Fg Ni	0.17	0.1	0.1	0.34	0.1	0.35

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 8), Kyle McConnell moved to approve the Rio Blanco County's request to add a Grass Mix Alfalfa (GMA) for forage (fg) with both an irrigated (Ir) and non-irrigated (Ni) practice as a NAP covered commodity for 2025 and succeeding years in Rio Blanco County as presented and shown above. Steve Raftopoulos seconded the motion. Motion passed.

8. Otero COC Actions

In accordance with 7 CFR 7.1(c), State committees will take any actions required by these regulations that have not been taken by a county committee. Don Brown, STC Chairperson, will electronically sign the documents for these actions.

A Supplemental Disaster Program (SDRP)

Presented by: Dara Belew, Otero/Crowley County Executive Director

1) Supplemental Disaster Program (SDRP) Stage 1

The STC reviewed policy, the SDRP Applications and supporting documentation that was presented by CED. See Exhibit 9, section 7.a.1 for details and list of producers whose CCC-526, SDRP Stage 1 Applications were reviewed. After reviewing the applications, Kyle McConnell moved and Joe Petrocco seconded the motions to approve the applications. Motion passed

2) Supplemental Disaster Program (SDRP) Stage 2

Presented by: Dara Belew, Otero/Crowley County Executive Director

The STC reviewed the SDRP Applications for State 2 that were approved by CED between meetings. See Exhibit 9, section 7.a.2 for details and list of producers whose CCC-504, SDRP Stage 2 Applications were acted upon.

B Livestock Indemnity Program (LIP)

Presented by: Dara Belew, Otero/Crowley County Executive Director

The application for 2025 LIP for Emma Richardson was tabled due to additional information submitted and the need to review the documentation and policy. See Exhibit 9, section 7.b.1.

C Common Management (CM)

Presented by: Dara Belew, Otero/Crowley County Executive Director

The STC reviewed the Farm changes that were approved by CED between meetings per delegations. See Exhibit 9, section 7.c.1 for details and list of producers and farm changes approved by CED.

D Payment Eligibility (PL)

Presented by: Dara Belew, Otero/Crowley County Executive Director

The STC reviewed the actively engaged determinations made by CED between meetings per delegations. See Exhibit 9, section 7.d.1 for details and list of producers that CED made actively engaged determinations on.

E Non-Insured Crop Disaster Program (NAP) Application for Coverage-late file

Presented by: Dara Belew, Otero/Crowley County Executive Director

1) Actual Production History (APH)

The STC reviewed the CCC-452, Actual Production History (APH) and Approved Yield Records for Crop Year 2025 were approved by CED between meetings. See Exhibit 9, section 7.e.1 for details and list of producers whose form CCC-452 were acted upon.

2) 2025 Production

The STC reviewed 2025 production records submitted and determined acceptable by the CED between meetings per delegations. See Exhibit 9, section 7.e.2 for details and list of producers that CED reviewed production records on.

9. Adjournment

There being no further business, the Executive Session was adjourned at 11:50 a.m. The next meeting is scheduled for June 24, 2026, in person and via TEAMS.

Approved:

State Committee Chairperson

Date

State Executive Director

Date

Colorado State Committee Meeting

Executive Session 5.28.2026

Exhibits

Page

Exhibit 1: CRP: 321 Equitable Relief – Misaction/Misinformation – Alamosa/Costilla.....	9
Exhibit 2: CRP: FY26 Additional Cost Share Component and Rate.....	61
Exhibit 3: EFRP: FY26 Additional Cost Share Components and Rates.....	64
Exhibit 4: ECP: Review of Average Market Land Value - Rio Blanco.....	77
Exhibit 5: NAP: 2026 NCT Colorado Cucumber Review.....	105
Exhibit 6: NAP: 2026 NCT New Crop request – San Miguel – Triticale FG Ni.....	147
Exhibit 7: NAP: 2025 NCT New Crop request – Dolores – Mixfg LLG FG Ir.....	155
Exhibit 8: NAP: 2025 NCT New Crop request – Rio Blanco – Mixfg GMA FG Ir & Ni.....	201
Exhibit 9: Otero COC: Action Items and Minutes.....	254